

[DOWNLOADABLE CHARTER](#)

Sustainability steering committee charter

By DS Consulting | consult-ds.com

A practical charter covering mandate, membership, cadence, and escalation for ESG delivery governance.

A note on how to use this resource

ESG programmes become fragile when meetings happen without clear decision rights, workstream ownership, or escalation logic. This charter gives leadership teams a simple operating structure that connects sustainability delivery, reporting readiness, and cross-functional accountability.

Right for CEOs, CFOs, CSOs, COOs, programme leads, and leadership teams creating a real ESG governance cadence.

SECTION 1: MANDATE

- ▣ Define exactly what the committee governs.
- ▣ Link the committee to named reporting and delivery obligations.
- ▣ State the escalation path to executive or board level.

SECTION 2: MEMBERSHIP MODEL

- ▣ Name the sponsor, chair, and secretariat.
- ▣ List standing members and invited subject-matter participants.
- ▣ Define workstream owner roles between meetings.

Use the checklist items below as working prompts. Replace placeholders with named owners, dates, and document links. Keep the final version in the same evidence location used for reporting, governance, or programme delivery.

SECTION 3: CADENCE AND PACK

- ☐ Set the meeting rhythm and pre-read timeline.
- ☐ Split agenda items into status, decisions, and risks.
- ☐ Carry a visible action log with owner and due date.

SECTION 4: ESCALATION AND CHANGE CONTROL

- ☐ Define how blocked actions are escalated.
- ☐ Track decisions that change scope, targets, or reporting assumptions.
- ☐ Archive packs, minutes, and decision notes consistently.

Suggested next step

Use the completed version as the working document for your next steering discussion, programme review, or submission-planning meeting. Once owners and dates are filled in, move it into the live governance cadence rather than leaving it as a static download.

Need help turning this into a live ESG operating model?

Use this resource as the working draft, then contact us if you want support with ownership, operating cadence, evidence design, or implementation.

[Contact us](#)